



Plant focus: roses

Reigning over the flower garden, roses are coveted for their exquisite blooms, tantalizing perfume, and long flowering season.

ROSES HAVE BEEN GROWN FOR THOUSANDS OF YEARS and are celebrated for their beautiful, scented blooms and diverse habits. Ranging from ground-hugging shrubs to lofty climbers, they never fall out of fashion and suit almost every design style, including contemporary, formal, and cottage. The flowers comprise many different forms, spanning the single flowers of the species to spherical, fully double blooms with 40 petals or more. Most of them are also fragrant, and while some roses only flower once a year, modern bushes and shrubs often perform for many months from summer to fall, especially when deadheaded regularly. In addition, species and old garden roses produce large, brightly colored hips to decorate designs through fall and winter. Roses suffer from a number of diseases, most notably black spot, which causes the foliage to discolor and drop off. To prevent it, buy modern resistant forms or tough species that tend to not succumb to the disease.

USING ROSES

Shrub roses can be trained as standards; you can use them in pots to flank a doorway or as a centerpiece in formal designs. The elegant flowers of bush roses enhance the color and fragrance of mixed herbaceous borders in informal gardens, and climbing roses can be trained to create curtains of color.

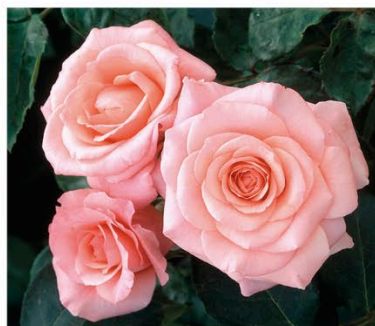


Species roses make excellent hedges with their tough, disease-resistant foliage and early-summer flowers, followed by decorative hips. Their thorns also help to deter intruders.

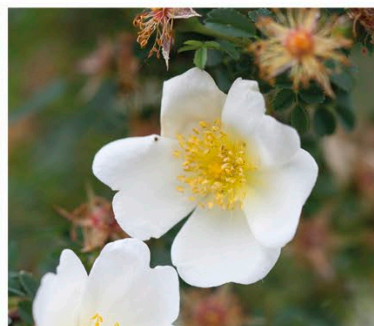
Climbers trained on wires fixed to a pergola or series of arches provide a tunnel of flowers, foliage, and scent in a traditional garden design.



TYPES OF ROSE



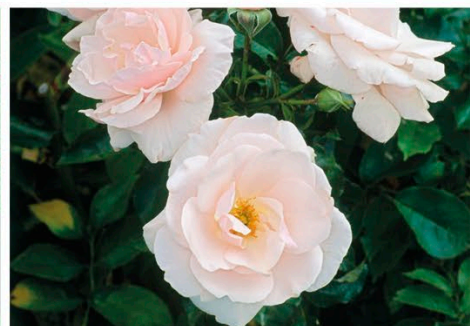
Modern roses This group, developed after 1867, includes the hybrid tea, floribunda, grandiflora, miniature, and English roses.



Species roses These can be divided into four groups by their place of origin, either Europe, America, the Middle East, or Asia.



Old garden roses Sometimes called heritage roses, this group includes gallica, damask, alba, centifolia, and bourbon.



Shrub roses Many shrub roses result from crossing old and modern roses to develop more hardy and disease-resistant selections.